The Means of Accomplishment of Glorious Hevajra

Śrīhevajrasādhana · Toh 1250 · Derge Tengyur
དཔལ་ཀྱེའི་རྡོརྗེའི་སྒྲུབ་ཐབས

The Means of Accomplishment of Glorious Hevajra, known in Sanskrit as the Śrī Hevajra Sādhana and in Tibetan as Dpal kye'i rdo rje'i sgrub thabs, is Toh 1250 in the Tengyur, where it belongs to the commentaries on the tantras. It is a short sādhana, or deity-practice manual, written mostly in verse by the master Sukhavajra for practitioners of modest understanding, and it sets out the meditation on Hevajra in his simple form with one face and two arms, surrounded by eight goddesses such as Gaurī and Caurī. Beginning with refuge, the mind of awakening and the four immeasurables, it leads the practitioner through the dissolution into emptiness, the visualization of the protective tent and celestial mansion, the generation of the deity and his retinue from seed syllables, empowerment, offerings and praise, and then the completion-stage practice of inner fire, followed by a torma offering and a closing reflection on the purity that each feature of the deity symbolizes. According to its colophon, it was translated into Tibetan by the Indian preceptor and translator Dharmacandra.

In Sanskrit: śrī hevajra dhanaṃ. In Tibetan: The Means of Accomplishment of Glorious Hevajra.

Homage to glorious Hevajra.

To glorious Hevajra,
To Gaurī and the others who dwell at the four gates,
And to the four goddesses who stir in the intermediate quarters,
I bow with faith in body, speech and mind.
For the sake of yogins of weaker understanding,
I shall compose, though I lack the ability,
This means of accomplishment
Of Hevajra with one face and two arms.

One who has heard it from the master himself,
Has properly received the empowerments,
Is skilled in meditation and ritual,
And has obtained the authorization,
With a mind that longs for accomplishment,
In a charnel ground or a temple,
In one's own house or on a riverbank,

Should meditate with no fear in the mind.

Through the seven kinds of recollection and release,
Having purified the seven, the body and the rest,
By the yoga of an instant
One makes one's body that of Vajrasattva.
At the heart, meditate on an eight-petaled lotus;
On it, imagine a sun disc and the syllable hūṃ.
Burning everything away with its blazing fire,
One is endowed with the eye of wisdom,
And sees directly before one
Hevajra and the eight goddesses.
With outer, inner and unsurpassed offerings
One worships them perfectly.

As the preliminary, one then prostrates,
Confesses the evil one has done,
Takes the vow not to do it again,
And rejoices in virtue done and being done.

"To the Buddha Hevajra,
To the Dharma that he taught,
And to the Saṅgha of the eight mother goddesses,
I go for refuge with a clear and faithful mind.
I too generate the mind of awakening;
I shall abide in the Great Vehicle;
For the benefit of all I give myself away;
And this too I shall dedicate far and wide."

First, cultivate loving-kindness;
Second, cultivate compassion in particular;
Third, cultivate joy;
And last of all, equanimity.

First, the mind of awakening that is emptiness;
In the second, the seed is gathered;
In the third, the form is completed;
In the fourth, the syllables are set in place.

After that, the awakening that is emptiness:
Without outer or inner, empty space.

Having reflected thus, one should meditate perfectly
On oneself as the body of suchness itself:
oṃ śunyatā jñāna vajra sabhāva atpako'haṃ.

Recollecting one's former aspiration,
One rises from suchness.
Below, on an eight-petaled lotus,
One imagines a sun and on it hūṃ;
From hūṃ it becomes the vajra ground.
Upon it one imagines the hūṃ that expels obstructors,
And with the sound rakṣa
One drives away the hosts of obstructors.
Gathering back, it becomes the vajra tent;
One should also meditate on the canopy.
Above, below and in every direction, the vajra expanse,
Meditated on as having the shape of a door.

Imagining the syllable e in form like Nairātmyā,
The source of phenomena that arises from it
Has the shape of a triangle,
White and pointing upward.
In its center one imagines
oṃ, raṃ, baṃ and lo.
Above them, one's own consciousness
Abides perfectly as oṃ itself.
Through the application of emanating and gathering,
It becomes the celestial mansion;
One should imagine it single-storied,
Four-sided with four gates,
Furnished with eight pillars,
Made beautiful by four porticoes,
Adorned with nets and half-nets,
And made radiant in divine form
By the light of the eight goddesses.

Then an eight-petaled lotus,
Red in color, on which a sun rests,
And on it the four māras arrayed:
Brahmā, Indra, Upendra (Viṣṇu) and Rudra,

Who dwell at the four gates, beginning with the east:
Brahmā, Indra,
Upendra and Rudra,
Each in his place in order.
In the four intermediate quarters are to be known
Yama, Kubera the Lord of Wealth,
Nairṛti and Vemacitrin;
They are to be visualized as the seats of Pukkasī and the others.
Thus the palace is complete in all its particulars.

One should act with this pride
Of being the source of the Tathāgatas,
And think of it as "I," as "myself":
oṃ sarva tathāgata vajra svabhāva ākophohaṃ.

On the central base, the vowels,
Sixteen, are to be known in two series.
They change into a moon, a twofold one:
This is the mirror-like wisdom.
Above it, one imagines perfectly
That from the consonants, forty doubled,
It becomes the seven-horsed sun:
This is the wisdom of equality.
In its center, arising from hūṃ,
Is a black vajra with five prongs,
Its hub marked with hūṃ:
This is the discriminating wisdom.
From it light radiates and accomplishes the aims of beings,
Then is absorbed into those four themselves.
That which becomes a mass of light
Is the wisdom that accomplishes activities.

From it eight drops break away:
go, rca, rghaṃ,
paṃ, sī, lo and ḍi,
Each fully endowed with moon and sun.
From the eight seeds there arise, in order,
A curved knife, a small drum, a tortoise, a snake,
A lion, a monk, a wheel,

And a vajra and the rest.
Gaurī dwells at the eastern gate;
Caurī dwells at the southern gate;
At the western gate, Vetālī;
At the northern gate, Ghasmarī;
Pukkasī in the northeast, the quarter of Īśāna;
Śavarī in the southeast, the corner of Agni the Fire-Eater;
Caṇḍālī dwells in the southwest, the quarter of Nairṛti;
And Ḍombī here, in the northwest, the quarter of Vāyu the Wind.

When the generation of the goddesses is complete,
The goddesses, seeing that the principal, a mass of light,
Is without a lord,
Make supplication to that supreme mass:

"With a mind of compassion, Blessed One, arise!
Pukkasī here: protect me!
Abandon the meditative absorption of emptiness
And grant me the bliss of desire!
If you do not remain, I shall die;
So cast off entirely the nature of emptiness,
And that Śavarī may attain the fruit,
O Hevajra, arise!
Lord of desire, who aspires for the sake of the world,
Why do you abide in emptiness?
If you do not remain, no direction can hold me:
I, Caṇḍālī, make this plea.
I, Ḍombī, am bewildered in mind;
Do not cut off the stream of your compassion,
But take me to your heart as your own,
And arise like a magical illusion!"

This is the song of exhortation.

Thus exhorted, recollecting
His former aspiration for awakening, he arises:
With one face and two arms, deep black,
Naked, with three eyes and bared fangs,
Fully endowed with the five mudrās,

A crossed vajra set upon his crown.
In his right hand he holds a five-pronged vajra;
In his left he holds a skull cup.
With his feet he tramples the four māras,
Standing with one leg extended and one bent.

Gaurī is black in color;
Caurī's color is like madder red;
Vetālī is the color of refined gold;
Ghasmarī is like an emerald;
The color of Pukkasī is blue.

Śavarī has the light of the moonstone;
Caṇḍālī is the green of the sky;
And Ḍombī is held to be of many colors.

Gaurī holds a curved knife in her right hand,
And in her left, likewise, a fish.
Caurī holds a small drum (ḍamaru) in her right,
And in her left a boar.
Vetālī holds a tortoise in her right,
And in her left a lotus vessel.
In Ghasmarī's right hand is a snake,
And in her left hand a skull cup.
Pukkasī holds a lion in her right,
And in her left hand she holds an axe.
Śavarī holds a monk in her right,
And in her left a rattle.
Caṇḍālī holds a wheel in her right,
And in her left she holds a skull cup.
Ḍombī holds a vajra in her right,
And in her left, likewise, the threatening gesture.
They stand in the dance posture with legs half crossed.
Gaurī and the others are known to have two arms,
Three eyes, and hair that stands upward;
They are supremely beautiful with the five mudrās,
And sit upon the seats of Brahmā and the others.

When the bodies are thus complete,
Imagine a lotus at your own heart.
In its center imagine a sun, and from hūṃ
A vajra with five prongs,
Marked in turn with hūṃ.
As it transforms, imagine the wisdom being.
That very lotus, sun, hūṃ and vajra
Make up the complete wisdom being.
In the same way, in all the stages,
One should know it thus within.

From it light radiates, and the Sugatas,
By the command jaḥ hūṃ baṃ hoḥ,
Are invited by Gaurī and the others
And absorbed; then the great wheel of wisdom blazes.
Accomplish the buddhas and bodhisattvas:
They exist nowhere else.

From mi comes Mohavajrī, the vajra lady of delusion;
From ḍi, Dveṣavajrī, the vajra lady of aversion;
From mi, Mātsaryavajrī, the vajra lady of avarice;
From raṃ, Rāgavajrī, the vajra lady of desire;
From i, Īrṣyāvajrī, the vajra lady of envy;
From rna, Nairātmyavajrī, the vajra lady of selflessness.
On the eyes, ears, nose, tongue,
Body and mind, set them in that order.
They have two arms and one face, sit on corpse seats,
And hold a curved knife and a skull cup in their hands.
From i is to be known Khecarī, the sky-goer;
From a is held to come Bhūcarī, the earth-goer.
From hūṃ generate the feet, imagining them below.
Thus body, speech and mind as well:
The yoginīs are held to be the three families.

From the seed at one's heart, emanate in particular
Rays of light in the form of hooks;
Invite the buddhas and worship them before you.
The empowerment is to be requested:
"Protectors, all you Tathāgatas,
Confer empowerment upon me!"

The Tathāgatas, the wrathful ones
And the deities, arrayed before one,
Confer empowerment with vases.

bicita, pipaka, bimarta, bila: these are the four moments. ānanda, paramānanda, biramānanda and samajānanda: these are the four joys. Laughing, gazing, holding hands and embracing are the master, the secret, the wisdom-knowledge, and the reality of great bliss.

At the end, as the fruit of the empowerments,
One is adorned at the root by Akṣobhya.
Adorned by the Mind, the Benefactor, the Jewel
And Amitābha
Are Gaurī, Caurī, Vetālī
And Ghasmarī.
Adorned by Akṣobhya, Buddha, the Jewel
And Amitāyus
Are Pukkasī, Śavarī, Caṇḍālī,
Ḍombī and the rest: these are the eight.
oṃ a sgyi ṣiñca tu rmā sarva tathāgata ho.

The blowing wind, the blazing fire, the skull cup,
The five holders and the five fruits
Transform into nectar to be tasted.
Imagining a vajra the size of a barley grain,
Hevajra recites:
oṃ sarva tathāgata amṛta svadana vajra svabhāva ākophohaṃ.

Emanating the eight goddesses,
With the eight offerings, as before,
One worships the lord of the maṇḍala himself:
oṃ sarva tathāgata phuja vajra svabhāva āko'haṃ.

Those yoginīs
Praise the lord of the wheel:
"You are encircled by the eight yoginīs;
Your intent is fulfilled by your own mind.
You who accomplish all of saṃsāra, moving and unmoving,
With a heart of compassion, for the awakening of beings,
Delight the mind of the one who practices through conventional illusion!"

oṃ sarva tathāgata stutir vajra svabhāva ātpakophohaṃ.

Having explained approach and close approach up to this point, I shall now explain accomplishment and great accomplishment.

Gather the deities of the maṇḍala into the body.
Kindle Caṇḍālī at the navel,
And burn the five Tathāgatas;
Burn Locanā and the others as well.
Through the burning, the hare-marked moon arises from haṃ.
First, one sees something like clouds;
Second, one sees something like smoke;
Third, the form of lightning;
Fourth, something like a lamp;
And fifth, everything is luminous,
Like a cloudless sky.
Afterward it is like the form of an illusion,
The form of a dream, momentary.
Right here at one's own heart,
Through the application of emanating and gathering,
Comes the application of meditation free of elaboration:
A flow without beginning, end or middle,
Without saṃsāra and without nirvāṇa,
Not so, and not an object of focus.
So it goes, up to "the tip of the lamp flame."

So that one is not hindered by obstacles and obstructors,
One should constantly give a torma:
oṃ inda ja ma ja la yakṣa bhūta bahni ba u rākṣa canda sru jja mā da ppa ta le pā tā la aṣṭa sabappa i daṃ ba li bhāṃ ja ji gha puṣpa dhū pa rmā sa piṃ gha aṃ bha sappa kajja sā dha khanti khu ni phe ḍa gā da oṃ a kā ro mu khaṃ sarva dharmā ṇāṃ ādya nutpanna tvā ta oṃ āḥ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā.
oṃ trelokyā kṣepa hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ svāhā: this is the heart mantra.

The yogin who is unable to practice meditative concentration
Should recollect the purities:
The red eyes are compassion;
The black limbs are loving-kindness;
The five mudrās are the buddhas;

Being wrathful, he tames the wicked;
The three eyes are the three bodies;
The bones are the four truths.
The aggregate of form is Vajrā;
Feeling is the secret Gaurī;
The aggregate of perception is Vārī, the water lady;
Formations are Vajraḍākinī;
Consciousness is Nairātmyā;
Ultimately there are no aggregates.
As for the purity of the six sense sources:
The eye is Mohavajrī;
The ear is Dveṣavajrī;
In the nose is Mātsaryavajrī;
In the mouth is Rāgavajrī;
In the body is Īrṣyāvajrī.
Earth is said to be Pukkasī;
The water element is Śavarī;
Heat is to be known as Caṇḍālī;
Wind is well known as Ḍombī.
Form is rightly called Gaurī;
Sound is called Caurī;
Smell is said to be Vetālī;
The nature of taste is Ghasmarī;
Touch is called Bhūcarī;
The sphere of phenomena is Khecarī.
Thus one should recollect the purities.

This sequence of my means of accomplishment
I composed for the sake of those of weaker understanding.
By whatever virtue there is in it,
May sentient beings be freed from saṃsāra!

The Means of Accomplishment of Glorious Hevajra, composed by the great master Sukhavajra, is complete.

It was translated by the Indian preceptor Dharmacandra, the translator Dharmacandra, as his own translation, and was revised and finalized.

The means of accomplishment of the one with one face and two arms is complete.

Translator's Notes

• The "seven kinds of recollection and release" renders the obscure phrase dran thar literally; the sense is uncertain. The eight seed syllables are announced but only seven appear in this text, where a word "and" seems to stand in place of one. "Shar rmi" at the eastern gate is read as "shar gyi," "eastern." The four māras are here identified with Brahmā, Indra, Upendra and Rudra, as in the Hevajra tradition. In the last line, the goddess called sbos mo is taken as Pukkasī, who is blue in the Hevajra Tantra and whose place in the color sequence this is. The line "no direction can hold me" (phyogs mi khums) is uncertain.
• "The Mind, the Benefactor, the Jewel" renders sems, phan pa and rin chen literally; they appear to stand for buddhas of the five families (rin chen for Ratnasambhava, and "Buddha" in the next set probably for Vairocana), but the identification of the first two is uncertain. "The five holders and the five fruits" ('dzin pa lnga, 'bras bu lnga) are rendered literally; they probably correspond to the five meats and five nectars of the inner offering. The verb bklag ("recites") before the nectar mantra is taken as written. The syllable chab in "a flow without beginning, end or middle" is obscure and is rendered tentatively. Although "six" sense sources are announced, only five are listed, as in the Tibetan. The author's name bde ba'i rdo rje is given as Sukhavajra.
• The colophon names "the Indian preceptor Dharmacandra and the translator Dharmacandra" and calls the work a "self-translation" (rang 'gyur); this is taken to mean that one Dharmacandra served as both paṇḍita and translator.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.